

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1043

By McNally

A RESOLUTION to honor Oak Ridge, Tennessee, as the "Birthplace of the Nuclear Navy," commend the work of Admiral Hyman G. Rickover and Dr. Alvin M. Weinberg, and memorialize the launching of the USS *Nautilus*.

WHEREAS, Oak Ridge, Tennessee, created during World War II as a centerpiece of the Manhattan Project, became a nationally significant center of nuclear science and engineering, and its people and institutions have continued that legacy of innovation and public service; and

WHEREAS, Oak Ridge National Laboratory—known in its earliest years as Clinton Laboratories—helped spread nuclear knowledge through training and research that influenced early capability in nuclear reactor technology; and

WHEREAS, Admiral Hyman G. Rickover, widely recognized for his decisive leadership in establishing naval nuclear propulsion, was associated with early reactor education and training connected to Oak Ridge, helping to accelerate the expertise required for the United States Nuclear Navy; and

WHEREAS, we specifically commend the visionary leadership and public service of Admiral Hyman G. Rickover, whose exacting standards shaped the United States Nuclear Navy, and Dr. Alvin M. Weinberg, a longtime leader in reactor science and national service whose work helped advance peaceful nuclear technology and the knowledge base essential to naval nuclear propulsion; and

WHEREAS, Oak Ridge's K-25 Site and its successor enrichment operations contributed enriched uranium for the USS *Nautilus* and for many naval nuclear propulsion reactors that followed, helping sustain the nation's Nuclear Navy; and

WHEREAS, the USS *Nautilus* (SSN-571), the world's first nuclear-powered submarine, was launched on January 21, 1954, marking a historic turning point in naval warfare and maritime endurance; and

WHEREAS, Oak Ridge's contributions—through scientific research, engineering innovation, workforce excellence, and national service—form an enduring part of the foundation upon which the United States Nuclear Navy was built and continues to operate; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Oak Ridge, Tennessee, as the "Birthplace of the Nuclear Navy," commend the work of Admiral Hyman G. Rickover and Dr. Alvin M. Weinberg, and memorialize the launching of the USS *Nautilus* (SSN-571) on January 21, 1954.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.